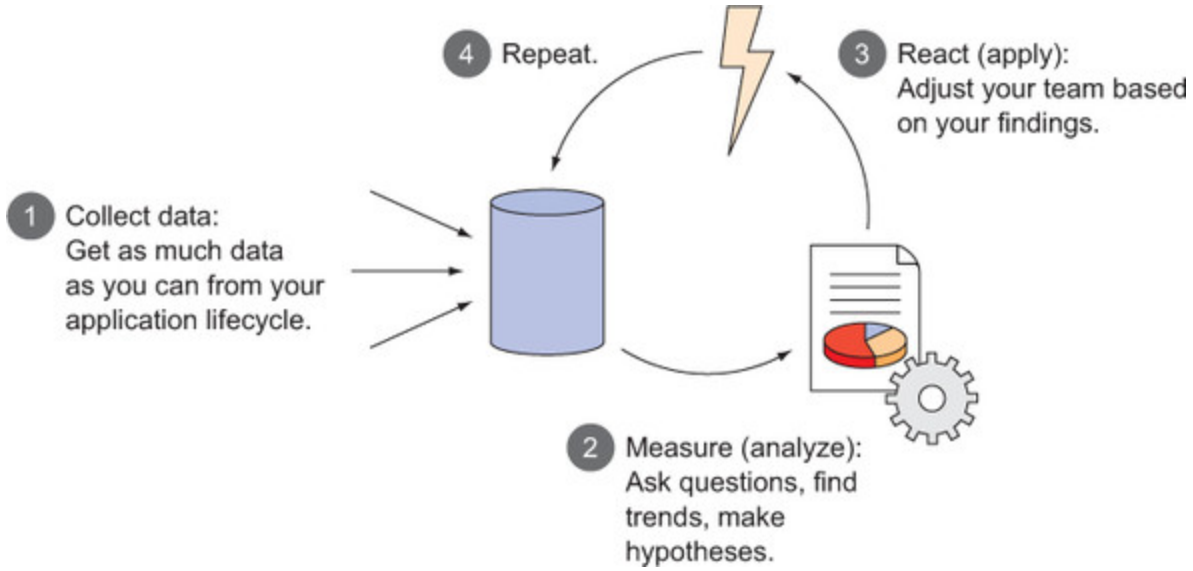
The feedback loop depicted in figure 1.1 naturally fits into the operations of agile teams. As you're developing, you're generating and collecting data; when you pause to check and adjust, you're doing your analysis; and when you start again, you're applying lessons learned and generating more data.

Figure 1.1. The feedback loop: collecting data from your process, asking questions, and tweaking your process



Continuous delivery and continuous improvement

The word *continuous* is everywhere in agile terminology: continuous integration, continuous delivery, continuous improvement, continuous testing, continuous (choose your noun). No matter if you're doing Scrum, Kanban, extreme programming (XP), or some custom form of agile, keeping your stream of metrics as continuous as your check-and-adjust period is key.

To begin you need to know where you stand. You're probably already tracking something in your development process, like what was accomplished, how much code is changing, and how your software is performing.